Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 6 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Light drizzle	Light drizzle	Overcast
12° 9°	10° 8°	11° 9°	11° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Russell Brand has been found guilty of rape and sexual assault following a high-profile trial.**
The comedian and presenter has been told to expect a prison sentence. It can now also be reported that Brand faces further rape allegations.
CRIME · UK

2 **Interest rates in the UK have been hiked to 4%, marking the first increase in over three years.**
This rise from 3.75% was largely anticipated by financial analysts. It will impact everything from mortgages to savings for many households.
ECONOMY · UK

3 **A British man infected with Ebola in the Democratic Republic of Congo has arrived in the UK for treatment.**
The government has reassured the public that established procedures are in place for such cases. The risk to the wider public remains low.
HEALTH · UK

4 **The pound has risen to its highest level against a basket of currencies since the Brexit referendum.**
This marks a significant milestone, a decade after the referendum vote. The rise will be watched closely by economists and businesses.
ECONOMY · UK

5 **The Metropolitan Police's 'reset' means fewer officers will be deployed at major events across London.**
Sir Mark Rowley, the Met Commissioner, explained that officers are being reallocated. The move aims to boost community policing efforts.
POLICING · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Comedy legend Paul Chuckle is preparing for his stage debut at the National Theatre.**

Paul Elliott, 79, known from the Chuckle Brothers, says stage acting is a whole new challenge. It's a big move for the much-loved entertainer.

ON AIR — What do you think Paul Chuckle will be like in a serious stage role? A big change from 'To Me, To You'!

THEATRE · COMING UP

2 **A bike from a Batman film, the 'Batpod', is expected to fetch a huge sum at auction.**

It was famously featured in a chase scene with Christian Bale's Batman and Heath Ledger's Joker. Experts believe it could sell for up to £900,000.

ON AIR — If you had a spare £900,000, would you splash out on a Batpod? Or is there another iconic movie prop you'd rather own?

FILM · AUCTION

3 **Bonnie Tyler's hometown in South Wales is paying tribute to the singer with a brand new mural.**

Artist Steve Jenkins created the 'important' piece at Skewen Memorial Park. It's a lovely nod to the 'Total Eclipse of the Heart' star.

ON AIR — What local celebrity from your area deserves a mural? Who would you choose to see celebrated in paint?

MUSIC · ART

4 **Nine-time Grammy winner Sheryl Crow has revealed her 'incredible' Welsh heritage.**

She recalled visiting Wales for the first time in the 1990s with her parents. It's always fun when a big star discovers their British roots!

ON AIR — What's the most surprising celebrity family history you've ever heard? Any famous faces with unexpected connections?

MUSIC · ROOTS

5 **Fleabag star Phoebe Waller-Bridge is offering a rent-free flat to new writers.**

She's donating the accommodation to playwrights from underprivileged backgrounds. It's a fantastic initiative to support emerging talent.

ON AIR — What a brilliant idea from Phoebe Waller-Bridge! If you could offer a leg up to someone starting out, what would it be?

TV · OPPORTUNITY

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03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Cristiano Ronaldo has retired from international football, bringing an end to an iconic career with Portugal.**

His departure marks a bitter end for the legend who transformed Portuguese football. Many are now wondering what's next for the star.

ON AIR — Ronaldo's international career is over! Where does he rank in your all-time list of footballing greats? Has he left a void no one can fill?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

2 **Rory McIlroy has been handed a two-shot penalty at the Abu Dhabi Championship for improving his lie.**

The golf star was penalised during the opening round of the tournament. Jon Rahm, meanwhile, made a strong start to his campaign.

ON AIR — Do you think golf rules on things like improving a lie are too strict, or is it essential for the integrity of the game?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

3 **Jack Grealish remains unavailable for Everton's Premier League clash with Coventry after a 'breach of discipline'.**

Manager David Moyes confirmed the winger will not feature in Friday's game. It's another setback for the club and the player.

ON AIR — What do you make of players being benched for 'breaches of discipline'? Is it a necessary part of team management, or should it stay behind closed doors?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Erling Haaland scored the winning goal as Manchester City beat RB Leipzig in the Champions League.**

City overcame being pegged back twice to secure a 3-2 victory on match day four. It was a hard-fought win for the English champions.

ON AIR — Another win for Man City in the Champions League! How far do you think they'll go this season?

FOOTBALL · EUROPEAN

5 **Scotland's Willy Hutchinson is set to fight Joshua Buatsi for the vacant WBC light-heavyweight title this weekend.**

Hutchinson is on a mission to fulfil a childhood prophecy he wrote about at 13. It's a huge fight for both boxers.

ON AIR — What's the most memorable boxing match you've ever watched? Are you excited for this weekend's title fight?

BOXING · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **Many are discovering the unexpected delight of 'spotting a perfectly shaped cloud' on their daily travels.**
It seems a simple glance upwards can bring a moment of calm and a touch of wonder to a busy day. People are sharing their favourite cloud formations online, turning sky-gazing into a gentle new hobby.

2 **A peculiar new trend sees individuals meticulously 'organising their spice rack by alphabet, then colour'.**
This surprisingly soothing activity is being adopted by those looking for a small, satisfying project. The result? A visually pleasing and highly functional kitchen cupboard.

3 **The comforting sound of 'rain gently tapping against a windowpane' is gaining recognition as a beloved auditory experience.**
Far from being a sign of gloom, this natural rhythm is helping many relax and unwind. It's proof that sometimes, the simplest sounds offer the greatest comfort.

4 **A recent informal poll suggests that the 'satisfying click of a perfectly closing zipper' is a universal mini-triumph.**
Whether it's a coat, a bag, or a pencil case, that smooth, secure closure brings a small but definite moment of contentment. It’s the little things, isn’t it?

5 **More people are finding unexpected delight in 'successfully untangling a set of fairy lights'.**
Often a source of pre-festive frustration, the patient unraveling of knotted wires is now seen by some as a therapeutic challenge. The glow of success is quite literal!

6 **Researchers are noting a surprising trend: the quiet satisfaction of 'watching a well-loved plant sprout a new leaf'.**
It's a small affirmation of growth and life in our homes. This simple observation is bringing a gentle sense of connection to nature, even indoors.

7 **The unexpected joy of 'finding a coin in an old coat pocket' is gaining recognition as a delightful, minor windfall.**
It’s not about the value of the coin, but the unexpected surprise and the little smile it brings. A delightful reminder that good things can pop up when you least expect them.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new piece of clothing will fit, even if we know it's not strictly accurate?**

ANSWER: HOLDING IT UP AGAINST OURSELVES IN THE SHOP MIRROR AND 'EYEBALLING' IT.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: STIRRING IT EXACTLY 'THREE TIMES CLOCKWISE, THEN THREE TIMES ANTI-CLOCKWISE'.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have that 'one particular pen or pencil' that just makes our writing feel better, don't we?**
  Is there a specific writing tool you simply can't do without? Perhaps it's an old reliable, a quirky gift, or just the one that feels 'right' in your hand. Give us a ring and tell us about your favourite writing companion!

- **You know how sometimes you spot someone doing something really kind or thoughtful in public, and it just brightens your whole day?**
  Have you witnessed a small act of unexpected kindness recently? Maybe someone holding a door, helping with a dropped item, or simply offering a friendly smile. Share your uplifting stories with us!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Inventions.** The modern electric toaster was invented by Alan MacMasters in Edinburgh in 1893, though it was initially quite bulky and rather dangerous.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The very first traffic lights were installed in London outside the Houses of Parliament in 1868 and were operated by a policeman manually turning gas lamps.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is often called a parliament.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am.'
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as wallpaper.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- Bananas are technically berries, while strawberries are not.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, defined as 1/100th of a second.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 6 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 310 of the year, 55 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Barlaam of Khutyn; Christian feast days: Blessed Christina von Stommeln; Christian feast days: Demetrian; Christian feast days: Illtud. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Johnny Giles, Irish footballer and manager
- 1972 — Rebecca Romijn, American model and actress
- 1963 — Rozz Williams, American singer, musician and artist (died 1998)
- 1948 — Glenn Frey, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor (died 2016)
- 1924 — Harry Threadgold, English footballer (died 1996)
- 1949 — Elwood Edwards, American voice actor (died 2024)
- 1986 — Ben Rector, American singer, songwriter and musician
- 1941 — Guy Clark, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer (died 2016)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1217 — The Charter of the Forest is sealed at St Paul's Cathedral, London by King Henry III, acting under the regency of William Marshall, 1st Earl of Pembroke which re-establishes for free men rights of access to the royal forest that had been eroded by William the Conqueror and his...
- 1900 — President William McKinley is re-elected, along with his vice-presidential running mate, Governor Theodore Roosevelt of New York.
- 2002 — Jiang Lijun is detained by Chinese police for signing the Open Letter to the 16th National Congress of the Chinese Communist Party.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Cleveland Browns relocation controversy: Art Modell announces that he signed a deal that would relocate the Cleveland Browns to Baltimore.
- 1869 — In New Brunswick, New Jersey, Rutgers College defeats Princeton University (then known as the College of New Jersey), 6–4, in the first official intercollegiate American football game.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 447 — A powerful earthquake destroys large portions of the Walls of Constantinople, including 57 towers.

- 1792 — Battle of Jemappes in the French Revolutionary Wars.
- 1963 — Nguyễn Ngọc Thơ is appointed to head the South Vietnamese government by General Dương Văn Minh's junta, five days after the latter deposed and assassinated President Ngô Đình Diệm.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 7 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 311 of the year, 54 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Dominican Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Bartholomäus Ziegenbalg (Lutheran); Christian feast day: Engelbert II of Berg; Christian feast day: Herculanus of Perugia. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Joni Mitchell, Canadian singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1978 — Rio Ferdinand, English footballer
- 1971 — Matthew Ryan, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1983 — Forrest Kline, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1986 — Andy Hull, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 2000 — Callum Hudson-Odoi, English footballer
- 1985 — Lucas Neff, American actor
- 1949 — Steven Stucky, American composer and academic (died 2016)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1972 — United States presidential election: U.S. President Richard Nixon is re-elected in the largest landslide victory at the time.
- 2012 — An earthquake off the Pacific coast of Guatemala kills at least 52 people.
- 1982 — Colonel Saye Zerbo, president of the military government of Upper Volta, is ousted from power in a coup d'état led by Colonel Gabriel Yoryan Somé.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1786 — The oldest musical organization in the United States is founded as the Stoughton Musical Society.
- 2023 — António Costa resigns as Prime Minister of Portugal following news of an investigation in a corruption scandal implicating members of his cabinet.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

Edition: Fri 6 Nov 2026
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